NEPAL
Cascading Hazards
& Early Warning Systems

Video Storyboard & Production Notes

10 Scenes | ~2 min runtime | 16:9 cinematic
Voice: Female EN (warm documentary)
Style: Photorealistic film stills

SCENE 01 Nepal — Living on the Edge



ON-SCREEN TEXT

NEPAL — LIVING ON THE EDGE

NARRATION

“Nepal, the roof of the world. Thirty million people live beneath eight of the planet's highest peaks. But this dramatic landscape is also one of the most hazard-exposed places on Earth.”

SHOT NOTES

Cold open. Slow drone-style aerial pull-back. Establish scale and majesty. Hold 12s. First frame must read as 'beautiful but dangerous frontier'.

SCENE 02

Cascading Hazards — One Trigger, Many Disasters



ON-SCREEN TEXT

CASCADING HAZARDS — ONE TRIGGER, MANY DISASTERS

NARRATION

“A cascading hazard is not a single disaster. It is a chain reaction. One event triggers another, and another, until the final impact far exceeds the original trigger.”

SHOT NOTES

Conceptual illustration of cascade. Slow-motion dust trail down the slope. On-screen text overlay on lower third. Hold 12s.

SCENE 03 Gorkha 2015 — Earthquake + 25,000 Landslides



ON-SCREEN TEXT

GORKHA 2015 — EARTHQUAKE + 25,000 LANDSLIDES

NARRATION

“In 2015 the Gorkha earthquake killed nearly nine thousand people. It also triggered twenty-five thousand landslides, stripping slopes, damming rivers, and setting the stage for the floods that followed.”

SHOT NOTES

Documentary realism. Static wide shot. Light brown landslide scars against dark forest. Hold 12s.

SCENE 04 Landslide & Glacial Lake Outburst Floods



ON-SCREEN TEXT

LANDSLIDE & GLACIAL LAKE OUTBURST FLOODS

NARRATION

“When landslides dam rivers, unstable lakes form. One aftershock, one monsoon downpour, or simply time can burst the dam, sending a wall of water rushing down the valley below.”

SHOT NOTES

Slow zoom onto the moraine dam. SFX: low rumble. Hold 12s. The fragility must read visually.

SCENE 05 A Warmer Climate, A Faster Cascade



ON-SCREEN TEXT

A WARMER CLIMATE, A FASTER CASCADE

NARRATION

“Climate change is accelerating every link. Glaciers retreat, permafrost thaws, extreme rainfall intensifies. A one-in-a-century flood may now arrive every decade.”

SHOT NOTES

Visual metaphor of climate intensification. Hold 12s.

SCENE 06 Melamchi 2021 — A Compound Cascade



ON-SCREEN TEXT

MELAMCHI 2021 — A COMPOUND CASCADE

NARRATION

“In June 2021 a complex cascade, landslides, a temporary dam, and intense rain sent the Melamchi river roaring through a valley, killing dozens and carving a new channel overnight.”

SHOT NOTES

Documentary still. Static. No people in frame. Hold 12s.

SCENE 07 Early Warning — Four Pillars



ON-SCREEN TEXT

EARLY WARNING — FOUR PILLARS

NARRATION

“An early warning system is four linked pillars. Knowing the risk, monitoring the hazard, communicating the warning, and building the capacity to respond. Break any one, and the system fails.”

SHOT NOTES

Slow push-in on the screens. SFX: ambient hum. Hold 12s.

SCENE 08

Community Flood Watch — People on the Front Line



ON-SCREEN TEXT

COMMUNITY FLOOD WATCH — PEOPLE ON THE FRONT LINE

NARRATION

“Across the Karnali and Koshi basins, volunteer watchers read river gauges. When water crosses the threshold, a phone call, a flag, and a siren cascade downstream, buying hours to evacuate.”

SHOT NOTES

Human element. Mid-shot. Hold 12s.

SCENE 09 From Sky to Valley — Tech-Augmented Monitoring



ON-SCREEN TEXT

FROM SKY TO VALLEY — TECH-AUGMENTED MONITORING

NARRATION

“Satellites track glacial lakes. Automatic weather stations beam rainfall data in real time. The Department of Hydrology and Meteorology runs flood forecasting, while ICIMOD monitors the cryosphere across the Hindu Kush Himalaya.”

SHOT NOTES

Static hero shot of the tech. Hold 12s.

SCENE 10 Anticipate the Cascade — Save Lives



ON-SCREEN TEXT

ANTICIPATE THE CASCADE — SAVE LIVES

NARRATION

“The future is multi-hazard, end-to-end early warning, anticipating the cascade before it begins. With investment, training, and trust, the next cascade does not have to become the next catastrophe.”

SHOT NOTES

Closing shot. Slow pull-back. Warm hopeful palette. Hold 14s. End card fades to black.